

RAFAEL CARBAJAL SANCHEZ

UX / Product Designer | Available June 2027

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

UX/product designer combining user research, interaction design, and AI-assisted development to create high-fidelity consumer app prototypes. Collaborates with design, engineering, and marketing teams; experience includes Snapchat local services, 26 interactive Pantri screens, and a deployed AI portfolio assistant.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (B.S.), Interaction Design

Santa Monica, CA

Santa Monica College | 2027

Relevant Coursework: Google UX Design Certificate, Coursera 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Design Scholar (Contract)

Jun 2026 - Aug 2026

Snap Inc. | Snap Design Academy

Los Angeles, CA

- Led product design for Resources, collaborating with engineering and marketing teams to turn an open prompt into a functional Snapchat local-support prototype in 3 weeks.
- Combined 2 rounds of partner research with SPY and St. Joseph Center and usability testing to refine information hierarchy, user privacy, trust signals, and handoffs to official services.
- Created UI components for Resources across Snap Map, Search, Spotlight, and sharing using component-based design; presented the prototype and design decisions to 300+ Snap employees.

UX Intern

Mar 2021 - Jan 2022

Plataforma Impact

Mexico City, Mexico (Remote)

- Designed UX/UI for 3 websites, including a B2B specialty coffee brand, and adapted layouts for an external client to improve clarity and conversion.
- Refined Figma layouts with the remote design team, translating feedback into website UI and supporting design implementation through technical spec handoff.
- Implemented front-end updates for a client website that launched and recorded a 33% increase in sales, collaborating with Engineering to resolve fidelity and style issues.

SELECTED DESIGN PROJECTS

Pantri

Jan 2026 - May 2026

- Used AI-assisted coding to build a high-fidelity React prototype with 26 interactive screens, covering onboarding, pantry tracking, meal planning, and completion with simulated data.
- Interviewed 13 grocery shoppers in-store to shape flows around budgeting, produce selection, substitutions, and changing routines, using user behavior insights to guide product design decisions.
- Tested Pantri in 3 rounds with 5 participants per round; prototyped recovery paths for substitutions, quantity changes, and skipped meals so users could adjust plans without restarting.

Nibble

Jun 2026 - Aug 2026

- Launched an AI portfolio assistant with conversational routing and contextual case-study links; handled 250+ visitor questions in its first 4 weeks.
- Developed context selection and response states to guide visitors to relevant projects; Vercel reporting showed project views per visit rising from 1.6 to 2.3 in the first 4 weeks after launch.
- Guided 52% of Nibble users to recommended project pages through contextual case-study links.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

UX Designer (Volunteer)

Aug 2026 - Present

Blocal

- Design Blocal's website layouts and information architecture, focusing on accessibility and the user experience.
- Build the organization's website, translating design layouts into working web pages.
- Facilitate collaboration between graphic designers and data analysts, managing schedules for 4 design workshops.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Design: End-to-end product design, interaction and UI design, high-fidelity prototyping, UI components, user flows, wireframing, information architecture, accessibility

Development: AI-assisted coding (vibe coding), React, JavaScript, HTML/CSS

Research: User interviews, usability testing, field research, research synthesis

Tools: Figma, Claude Code, Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign